

When three South African wickets fell in India's must-win Super League game, Team Manager Lalchand Rajput noticed Graeme Smith begin to twitch and send out a message to his batsmen: "All we need is 126." The Indian fielders were told instantly and their intensity cranked up a notch. When Yuvraj went out to bat in the semi-final versus Australia, Brad Hogg asked loudly, "Wonder who's going to hit six sixes today?" Yuvraj's first scoring shot sailed over the ropes and the Indians on the bench began to count down, "Five, four" again just audible enough for the Aussies seated a few feet away.

The collective fabric of the Indian team, frayed by the result of the West Indies World Cup, has patched itself together again after the tours of England and now the World T20 victory. When Yousuf Pathan, the older and less decorated brother of Irfan, found out he was to make his debut in the final, he was given precious advice by Sehwag, the man he had replaced, "Celebrate it, enjoy it."

Now that the World T20 is over, it is time to exhale, stand back and contemplate calmly what awaits India. India play the Australians next in what promises to be a bruising seven-match ODI series and the new captain's real baptism by hellfire and brimstone. Only now will Dhoni step on to the exhausting factory floor that is Indian cap-

The Twenty20 Bonanza

■ Team India earns \$490,000 (almost Rs 2 crore) as prize money for winning the Twenty20 World Cup.

■ BCCI gives a bonus of \$3 million (almost Rs 12 crore) to the Indian team. Each team member gets approximately Rs 80 lakh.

YUVRAJ SINGH: Rs 1 crore for hitting six sixes in an over. Also a Porsche 911 worth Rs 90 lakh as personal gift from BCCI General Secretary Lalit Modi.

ROHIT SHARMA AND AJIT AGARKAR: Rs 10 lakh each from the Maharashtra Government.

JOGINDER SINGH: Rs 21 lakh from the Haryana Government.

ROBIN UTHAPPA, VENKATESH PRASAD: Rs 5 lakh each from the Karnataka Government.

R.P. SINGH: Rs 10 lakh from the Uttar Pradesh Government.

M. S. DHONI: Will get a surprise gift from the Jharkhand chief minister.

GAUTAM GAMBHIR AND VIRENDER SEHWAG: Rs 5 lakh each from the Delhi Government.

S. SREESANTH: Rs 5 lakh from the Kerala Government.

SUPPORT STAFF: Rs 15 lakh each from BCCI

M.S. DHONI, YUVRAJ SINGH, IRFAN PATHAN, HARBHAJAN SINGH, R.P. SINGH, ROBIN UTHAPPA: Out-of-turn promotions and free travel from Air India. Also, free travel benefits for all the 15 team members and their family members for five years on Air India.

EACH TEAM MEMBER will get a house by Sahara India in Sahara City Homes, costing Rs 4 crore.

taincy, with a complete understanding of how heavy India's expectation of its cricketers can be. It is one thing to see off Brett Lee's opening spell of two overs, it is quite an-

other to have to face him for five. It is one thing to have a free rein to play strokes, it is another to have to wait to pick your moment when being suffocated by the field.

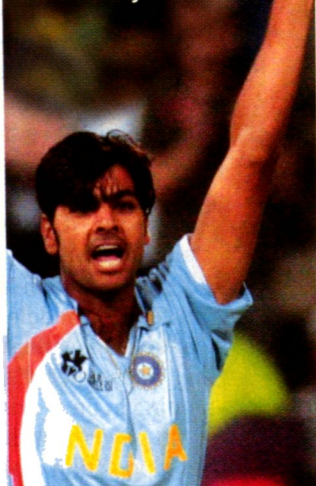
The resounding success of a refashioned limited-over team will, in the next few weeks, turn the spotlight on India's older players, specially the big three—Sachin Tendulkar, Rahul Dravid and Sourav Ganguly. Can the skipper handle the unbearable heaviness of being India captain? Can R.P. Singh sustain his consistency, Gambhir his improvement, Yuvraj his domination? Can Uthappa maximise

Young Heroes who performed when it mattered



YUVRAJ SINGH: His 30-ball 70 was crucial for India's victory against Australia.

R.P. SINGH: He gave India important breakthroughs whenever needed, consistently.



IRFAN PATHAN: Back with the swing, he demolished Pakistan's middle order in the final.



GAUTAM GAMBHIR: His 75 ensured that the final did not swing the other way.